

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠5

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠10

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♦

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣7

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

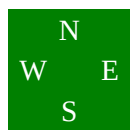
Lead: ♣K

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ 10 9 8 5
♦ 8 7 6 5
♣ 7 6 4

♠ A 8 7 6
♥ Q J 7
♦ A J 3
♣ A 8 2



♠ 10 5 3
♥ A 4 3 2
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 3

♠ K Q J 4
♥ K 6
♦ K 4
♣ K Q J 10 5

When NORTH opens 1NT SOUTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 5			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 2
 ♥ K J 5 3
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ 7 6 4 2

♠ 8 5 4 3

♥ 7 4

♦ 10 8 6 4

♣ Q 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K

♥ A Q 10 9 6

♦ A Q J 3

♣ A K

♠ Q J 10 6

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 5 2

♣ J 9 8 5

EAST has a pretty good hand, and when WEST shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding WEST with two Kings was what she wanted.

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	5NT	Pass
6♥	Pass	7NT	
All Pass			
7NT by East			
Lead: ♠Q			

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 9 5

♥ Q 8 5 3

♦ 9 8 2

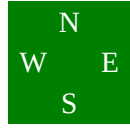
♣ 5 4

♠ K 7

♥ K 9

♦ A Q J 10 4

♣ A Q J 7



♠ J 8 4 3

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ 6 3

♣ 10 9 3

♠ A 6 2

♥ A 10 4

♦ K 7 5

♣ K 8 6 2

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♠10			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ K J 9 7 4
 ♣ A Q J 9 2

♠ J 8 4 3
 ♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5
 ♥ 7
 ♦ Q 10 6 5 3
 ♣ K 10 8 4

♠ Q 10 9 7 2
 ♥ A Q J 6
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ 6 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	3 ♦	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5 ♦	
All Pass			
5 ♦ by West			
Lead: ♣ 7			

WEST thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ K J 10 2
 ♣ J 9 6 3

♠ K 4

♥ K Q 10 9 5

♦ A 7 6

♣ A 5 4



♠ 10 9 6

♥ 7 2

♦ Q 9 8 4

♣ K Q 10 2

♠ A Q J 7 3

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7

NORTH knows SOUTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, SOUTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces NORTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♣K			